

THE DIVORCE revolution

▼ Divorce rally

In 1970, divorce was introduced in Italy, but the country held many subsequent debates over whether the law should be abolished. These 1970s campaigners rally to keep divorce legal.

THE MODERN DIVORCE

In the 1960s and 1970s, divorce law in most Western countries was based on the concept of fault. With a few exceptions, if one spouse wished to get a divorce while the other did not, the procedure was difficult. Divorce could only be granted if the petitioner proved that their spouse had broken the marital contract, for example, through adultery, abandonment, or even sexual impotence.

Some scholars argued that the fault system contributed to spousal homicide and suicide by women who felt trapped in bad marriages.

Communist Russia was ahead of its time with no-fault divorces, in which neither party were blamed, which were allowed from 1917.

